

DHL Group

Warehouse Operations & Safety Policy

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1. Purpose & Scope

This policy establishes mandatory operational and safety standards for all DHL Group warehouse facilities worldwide. It applies to all employees, contractors, and temporary workers operating in DHL-owned or DHL-managed warehouse environments.

Scope includes: DHL Supply Chain warehouses, DHL Express sorting centers, DHL Freight cross-dock facilities, and DHL eCommerce fulfillment centers across all regions (EMEA, Americas, APAC).

2. Receiving & Inbound Procedures

2.1 Dock Door Assignment: All inbound vehicles must be assigned a dock door via the Warehouse Management System (WMS) before unloading begins. Drivers must check in at the gatehouse and present a valid booking reference.

2.2 Inspection Protocol: Every inbound shipment requires a visual inspection within 30 minutes of dock arrival. Check for: (a) packaging integrity, (b) correct item count vs. ASN, (c) temperature compliance for cold-chain goods, (d) hazardous materials labeling per ADR/IMDG standards.

2.3 Discrepancy Handling: Any discrepancy between the ASN and physical count must be logged in WMS within 2 hours. For discrepancies exceeding 5% of shipment value, escalate to the Shift Supervisor and notify the customer within 4 hours.

2.4 Cold Chain Receiving: Temperature-sensitive goods must be moved to the appropriate temperature zone within 15 minutes of unloading. Temperature loggers must be retrieved and data uploaded to the Quality Management System (QMS) within 1 hour.

3. Storage & Inventory Management

3.1 Slot Assignment: All items must be stored in WMS-assigned locations. Manual overrides require Shift Supervisor approval. High-value items (>EUR 5,000 per unit) must be stored in the secured cage area with dual-access controls.

3.2 FIFO/FEFO Compliance: First-In-First-Out (FIFO) is the default rotation method. First-Expired-First-Out (FEFO) is mandatory for all food, pharmaceutical, and chemical products. Compliance is audited monthly.

3.3 Cycle Counting: ABC cycle counting must be performed according to the following schedule: A-items (top 20% by value) = weekly, B-items = bi-weekly, C-items = monthly. Variance threshold for investigation: 1% for A-items, 3% for B/C-items.

3.4 Hazardous Materials Storage: Hazmat items must be stored in designated areas with proper ventilation, spill containment, and fire suppression systems. Maximum storage quantities per fire compartment are defined in Appendix C. Incompatible materials must maintain minimum 3-meter separation.

4. Picking & Packing Standards

4.1 Pick Accuracy Target: Minimum 99.8% pick accuracy across all operations. Errors exceeding 0.5% in any given week trigger a root cause analysis (RCA) within 48 hours.

4.2 Packaging Requirements: All outbound packages must use DHL-approved packaging materials. Temperature-sensitive pharmaceuticals require validated insulated packaging with minimum 72-hour thermal protection. Documentation must include: product name, batch number, storage temperature range, and handling instructions in both origin and destination country languages.

4.3 Labeling: Every outbound package requires: (a) DHL shipping label with barcode, (b) customer-specific labels as per SOP, (c) hazmat labels per IATA DGR / ADR where applicable, (d) fragile/orientation labels where needed.

4.4 Quality Checks: Random quality audits must cover minimum 5% of daily outbound volume. Results are logged in QMS and reported weekly to the Site Manager.

5. Safety & Emergency Procedures

5.1 Personal Protective Equipment (PPE): Mandatory PPE in all warehouse areas: safety shoes (S3 rated), high-visibility vest. Additional PPE by zone: cold storage (thermal jacket, gloves), battery charging area (safety goggles, acid-resistant gloves), hazmat zone (full PPE as specified in MSDS).

5.2 Forklift Operations: Only certified operators may operate forklifts. Certification must be renewed every 3 years. Pre-shift inspection checklist must be completed before first use. Speed limit: 10 km/h in aisles, 5 km/h at intersections. Pedestrian priority at all times.

5.3 Emergency Evacuation: Evacuation drills must be conducted quarterly. Assembly points are marked on facility maps posted at every exit. Fire wardens conduct headcount within 5 minutes of alarm activation. Facility must be fully evacuated within 8 minutes.

5.4 Incident Reporting: All incidents (including near-misses) must be reported via the DHL Safety Portal within 24 hours. Lost-time injuries must be reported to Regional Safety Manager within 4 hours. Root cause analysis required for all LTI events within 5 business days.

6. Shift Handover Protocol

6.1 Handover Meeting: A structured handover meeting of minimum 15 minutes must occur at every shift change. The outgoing Shift Supervisor must brief the incoming team on: (a) open orders and priority shipments, (b) equipment issues or maintenance in progress, (c) safety incidents or near-misses, (d) staffing levels and any absences, (e) customer escalations.

6.2 Handover Log: A digital handover log must be completed in the WMS Shift Module before the outgoing supervisor leaves the facility. Key fields: KPI summary (units processed, error rate, on-time dispatch rate), open issues with assigned owners, equipment status.

6.3 Cross-Shift Communication: For urgent matters that cannot wait for the next handover meeting, the designated Teams channel "WH-Ops-Urgent" may be used. All messages in this channel must also be logged in WMS within the next business day.